50 Chess Puzzles for Kids

A chess-vision pack: look at the board, find the move, write it down. From first checkmates to real sacrifices.



Beginner · 1 to 15
One-move checkmates and simple forks. Under 600, or just starting.

Intermediate · 16 to 35
Two-move pins, discovered attacks and deflections. About 600 to 1000.

Advanced · 36 to 50
Three-move sacrifices for aspiring club players. 1000 and up.

For the grown-up

1. **One puzzle at a time.** Each says whose turn it is; the board is drawn from that side, so the player always looks "up" the board.
2. **Write it down.** There are lines under every puzzle. Squares are named by the letters along the bottom and the numbers up the side (a1 to h8).
3. **Set it up if it helps.** Copying a puzzle onto a real board trains the same skill: seeing the move before playing it.
4. **Check afterwards.** The answers are on the last two pages, with the reply the other side will make.
5. **Stuck?** The hint under each puzzle says what to look for. Coming back to a puzzle tomorrow works surprisingly often.

Print double-sided and staple the left edge to make a 16-page booklet.

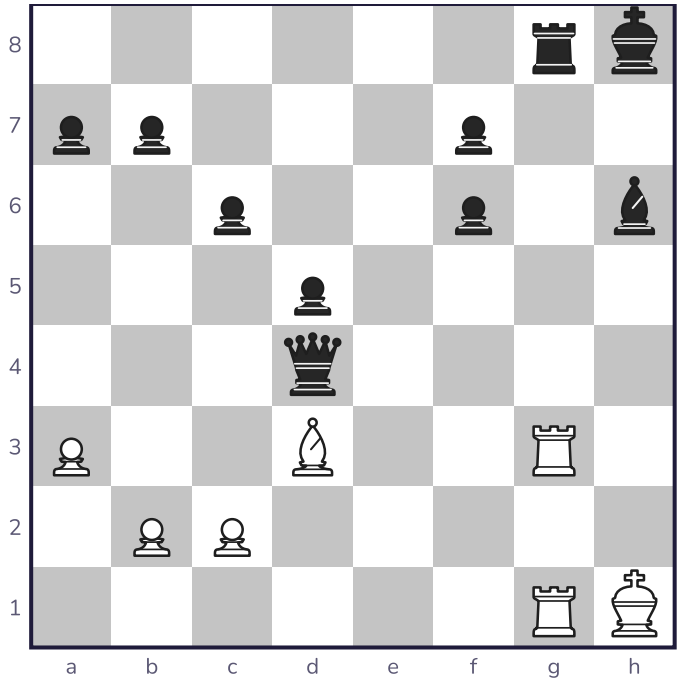
Puzzles from the Lichess puzzle database (free to use, CC0; database.lichess.org), each checked move by move. Pieces from RankUp Chess, our offline chess academy for kids, which has 30,000+ puzzles like these.

Puzzles 1 to 4

Name: _____

1 BEGINNER

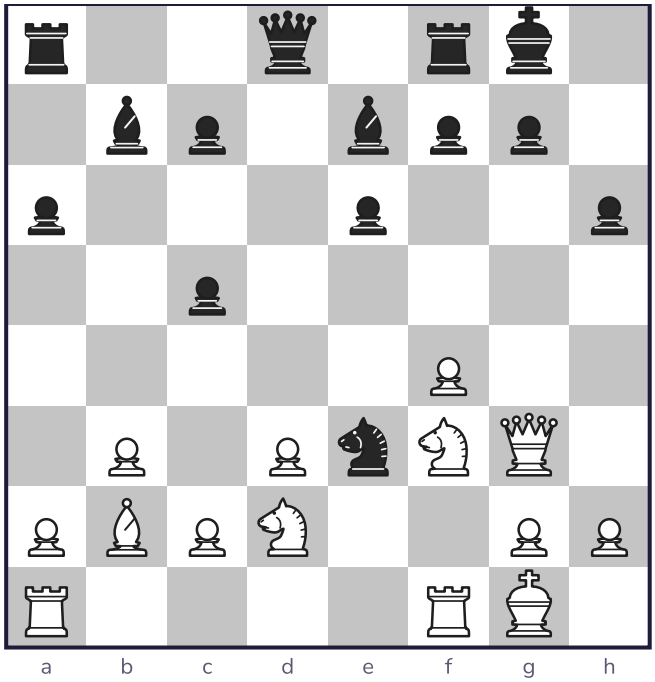
White to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

2 BEGINNER

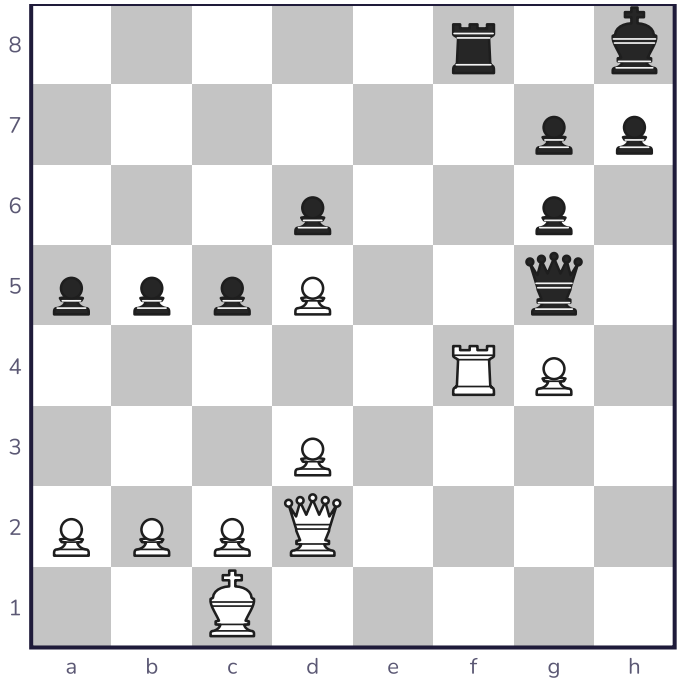
White to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

3 BEGINNER

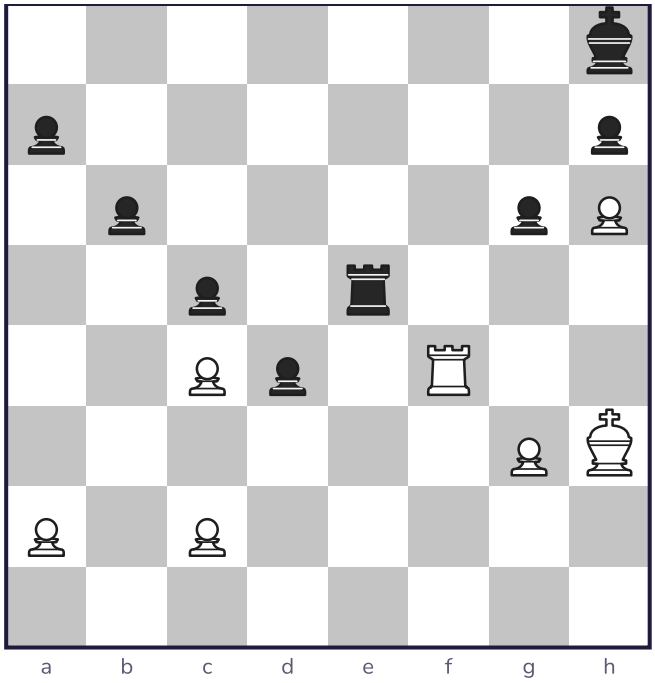
White to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

4 BEGINNER

White to play



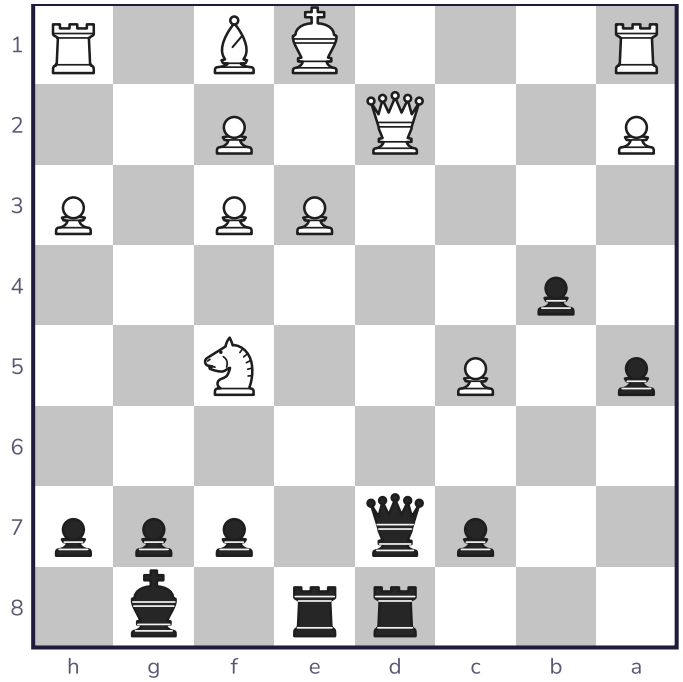
Find checkmate in 1 move.

Puzzles 5 to 8

Name: _____

5 BEGINNER

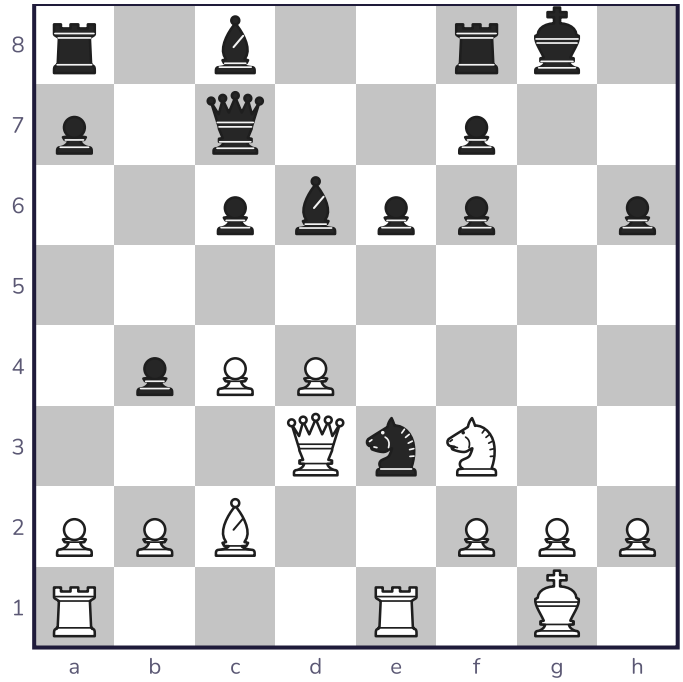
Black to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

6 BEGINNER

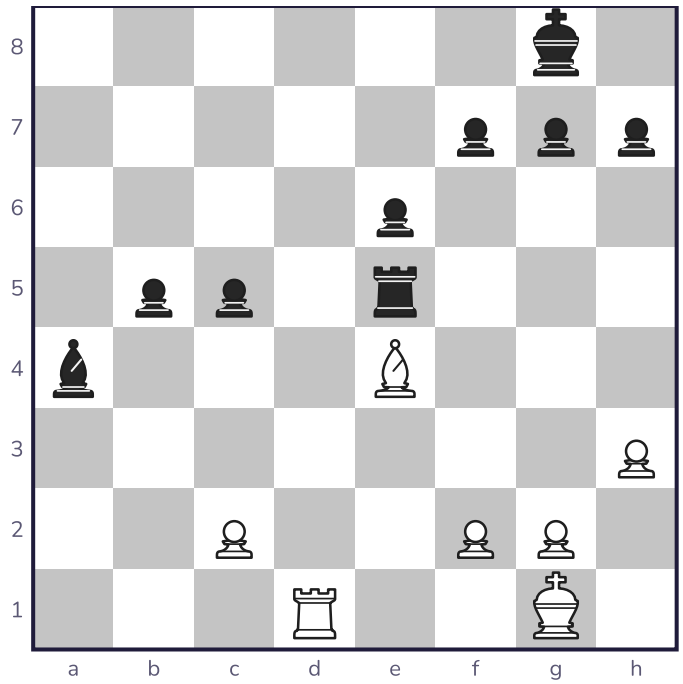
White to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

7 BEGINNER

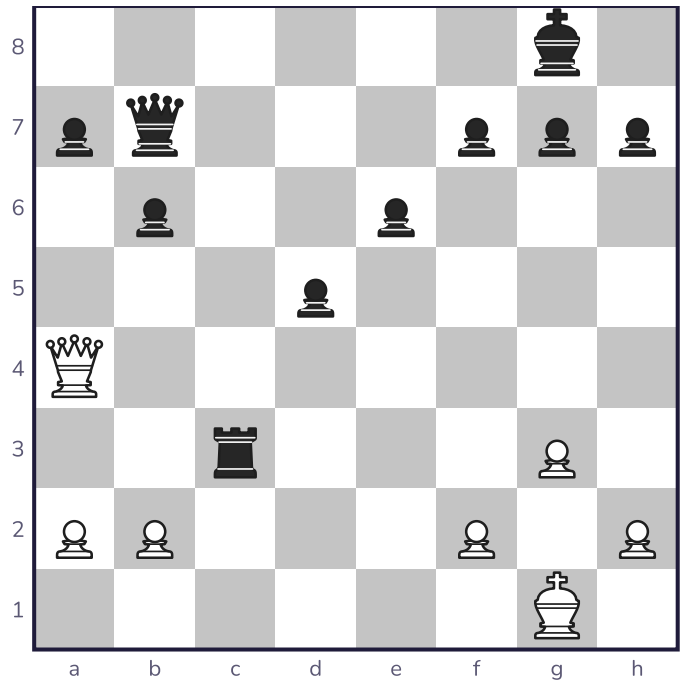
White to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

8 BEGINNER

White to play



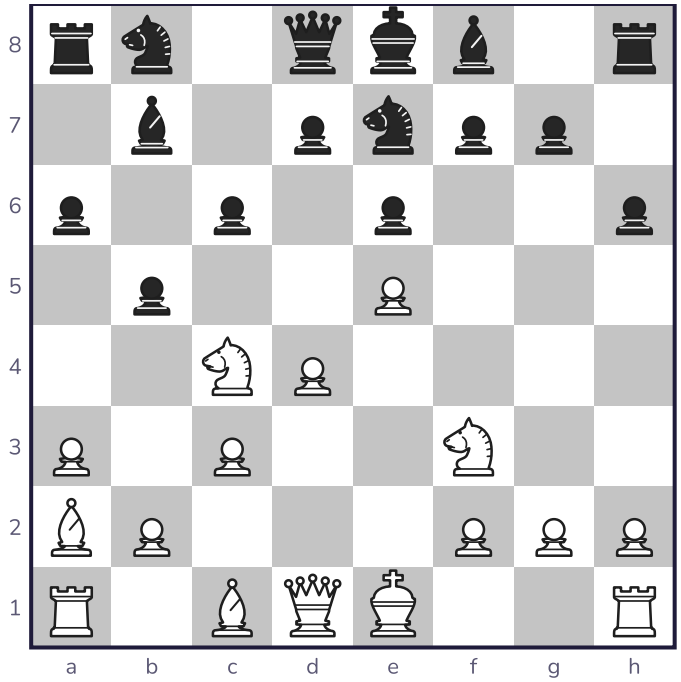
Find checkmate in 1 move.

Puzzles 9 to 12

Name: _____

9 BEGINNER

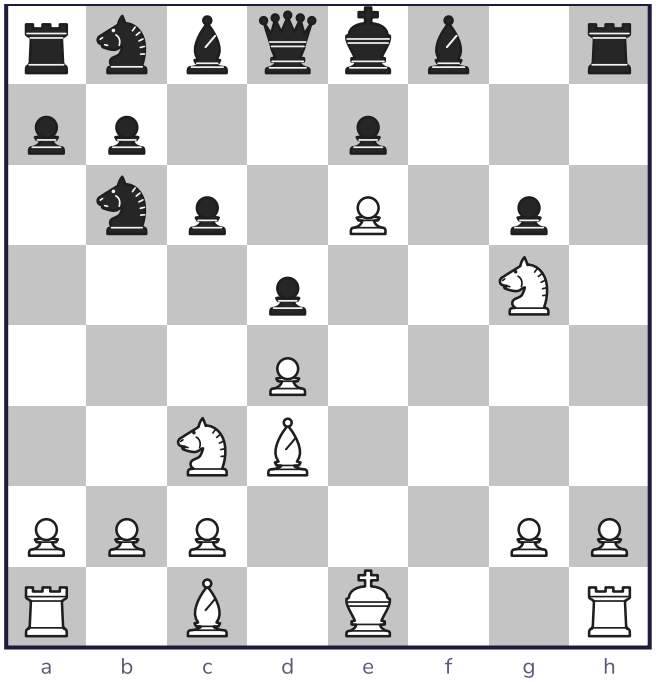
White to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

10 BEGINNER

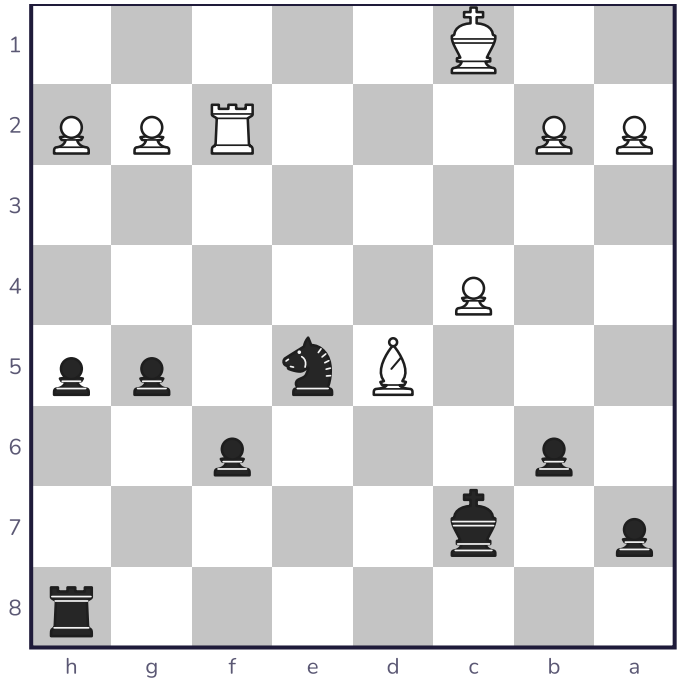
White to play



Find checkmate in 1 move.

11 BEGINNER

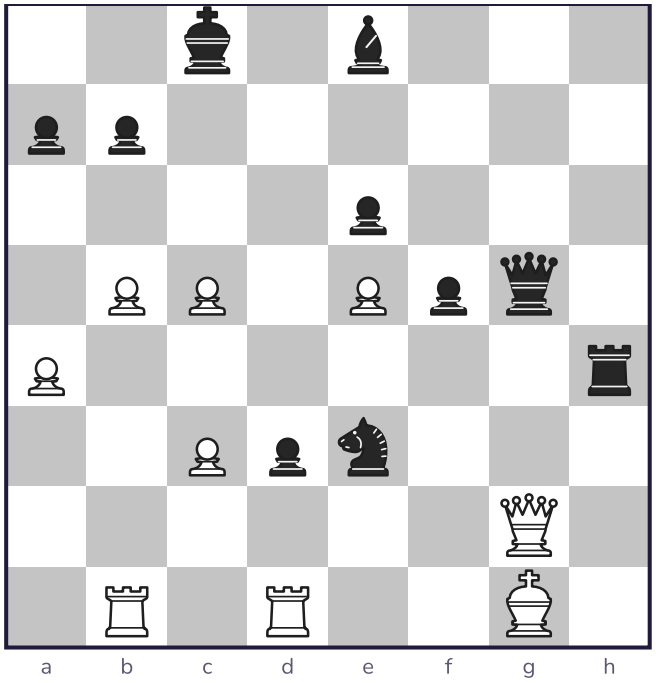
Black to play



Find a fork: one move that attacks two pieces, then take one.

12 BEGINNER

White to play

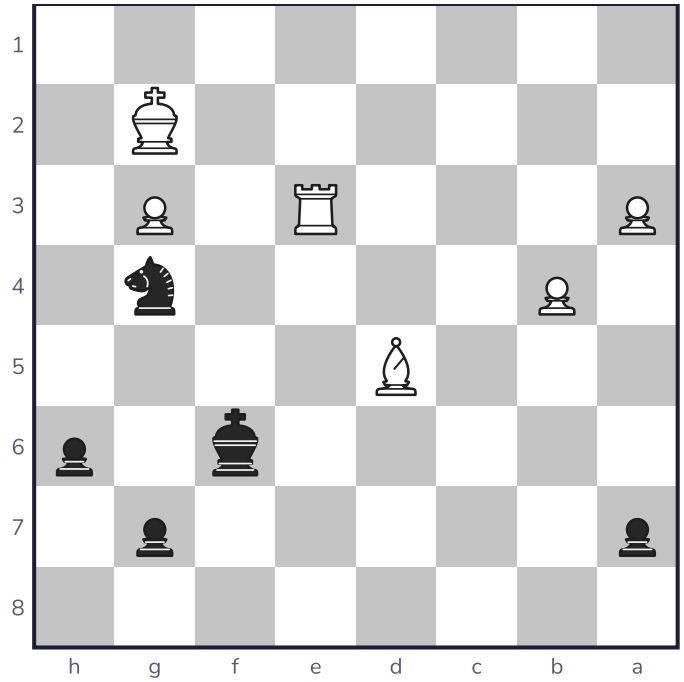


Find a fork: one move that attacks two pieces, then take one.

Puzzles 13 to 16

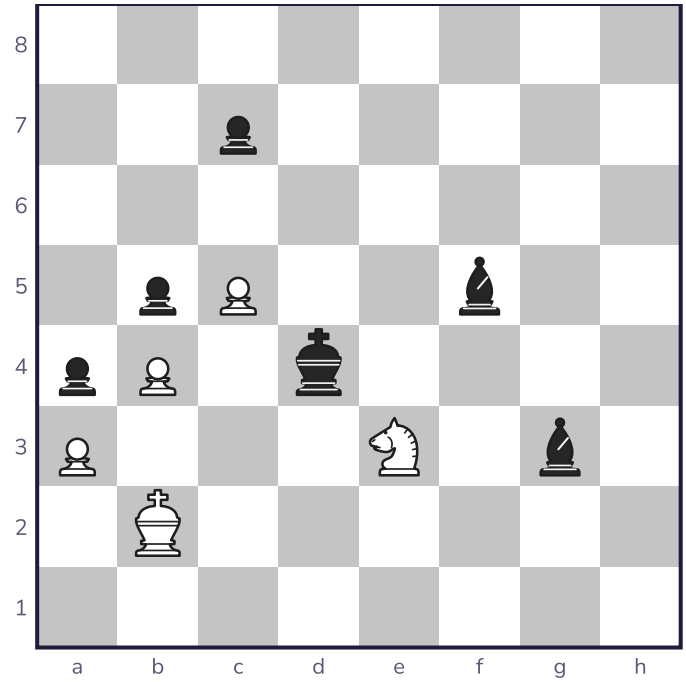
Name: _____

13 BEGINNER — Black to play



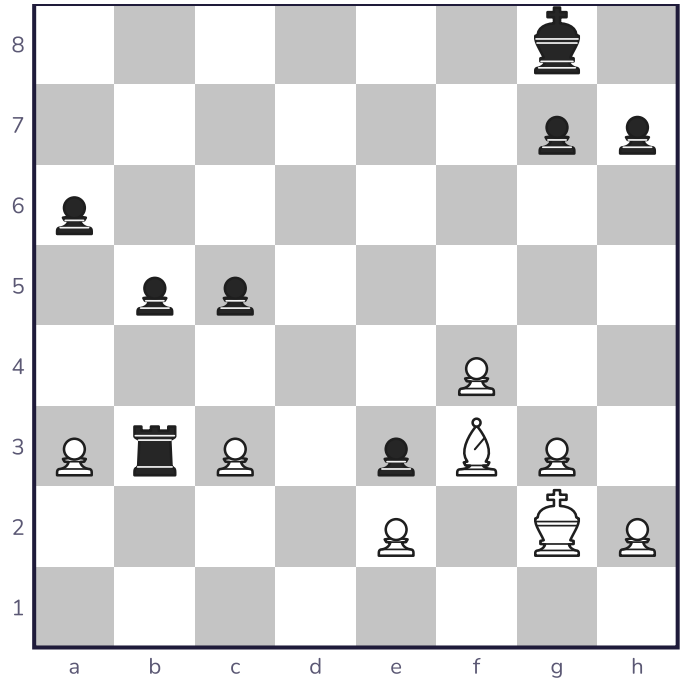
Find a fork: one move that attacks two pieces, then take one.

14 BEGINNER — White to play



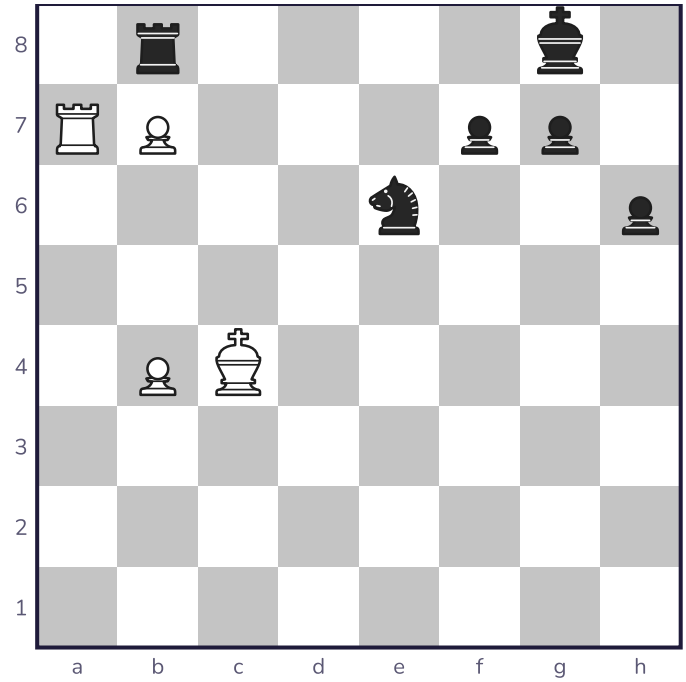
Find a fork: one move that attacks two pieces, then take one.

15 BEGINNER — White to play



Find a fork: one move that attacks two pieces, then take one.

16 INTERMEDIATE — White to play

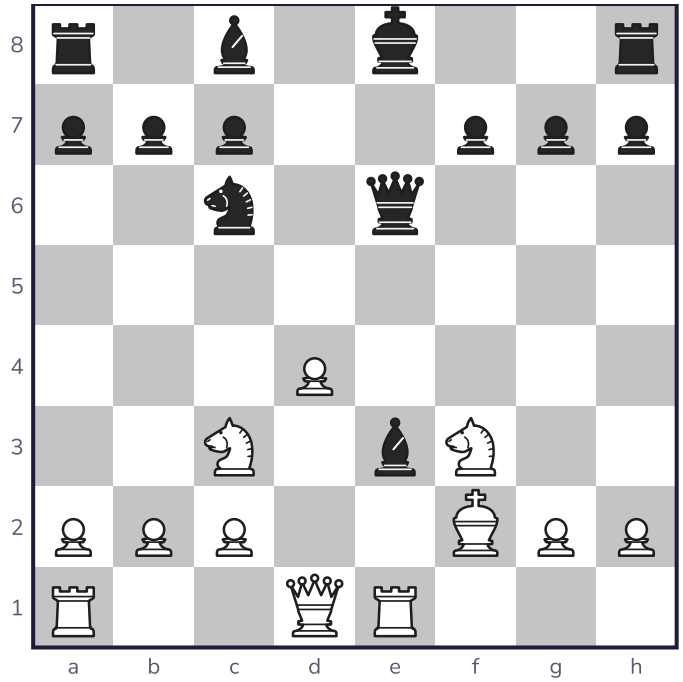


Two moves. Look for a pin.

Puzzles 17 to 20

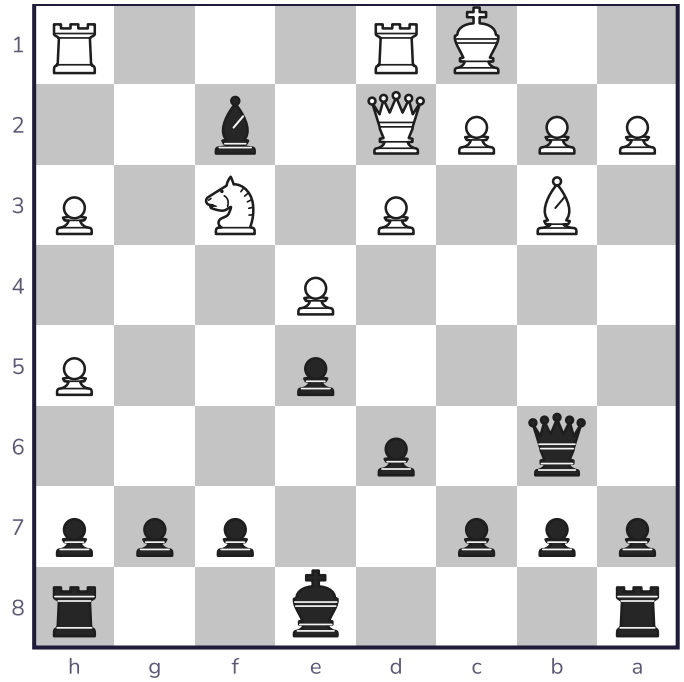
Name: _____

17 INTERMEDIATE — White to play



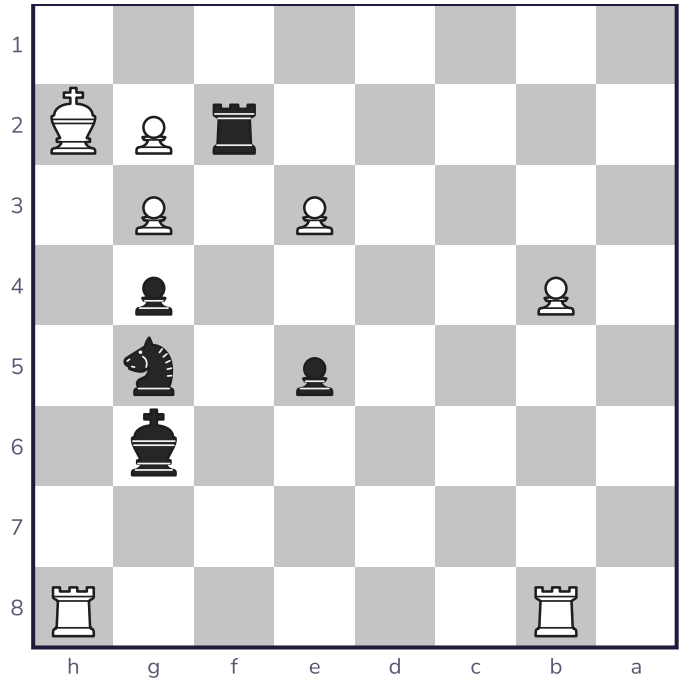
Two moves. Look for a pin.

18 INTERMEDIATE — Black to play



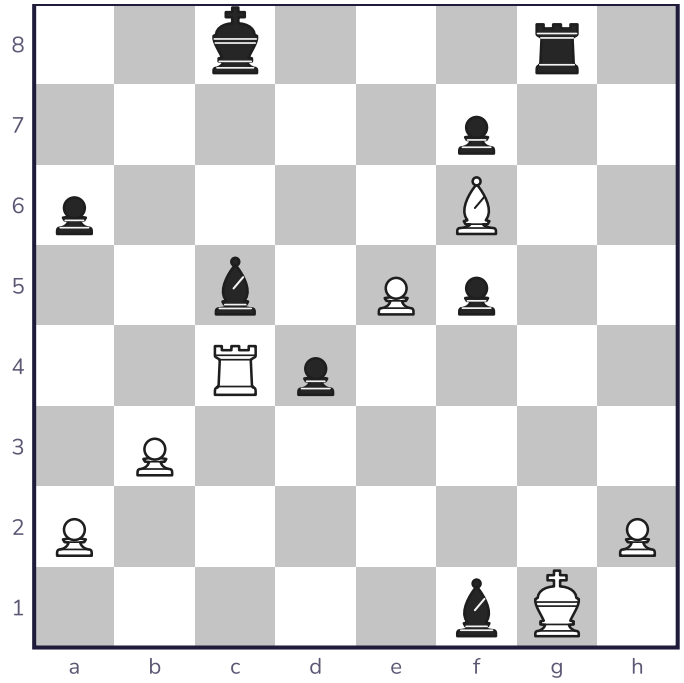
Two moves. Look for a pin.

19 INTERMEDIATE — Black to play



Two moves. Look for a pin.

20 INTERMEDIATE — White to play

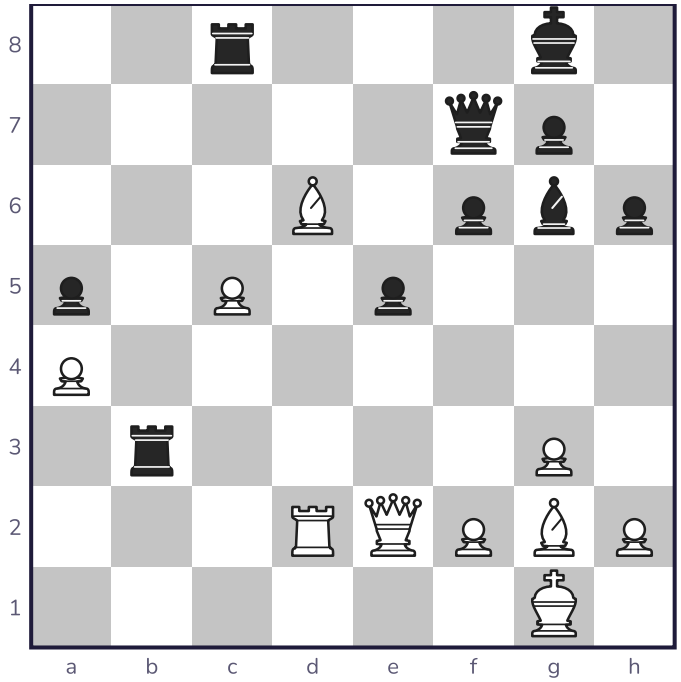


Two moves. Look for a pin.

Puzzles 21 to 24

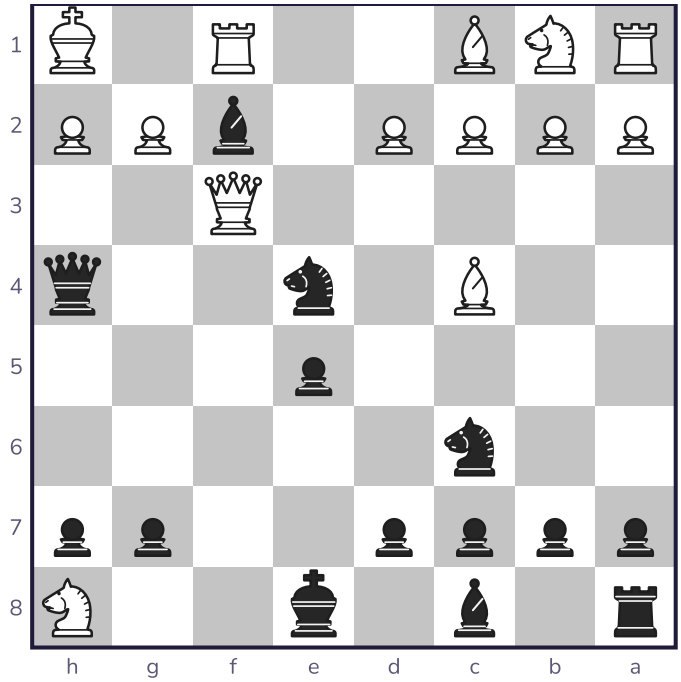
Name: _____

21 INTERMEDIATE — White to play



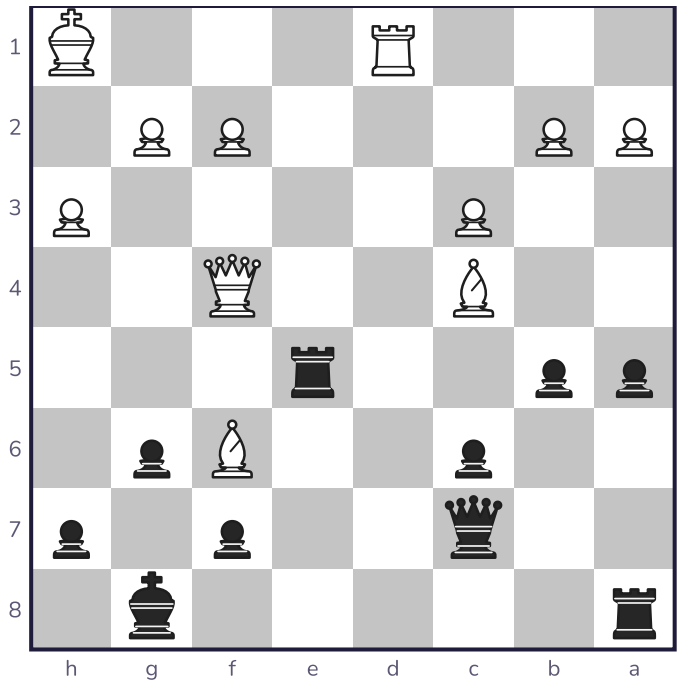
Two moves. Look for a pin.

22 INTERMEDIATE — Black to play



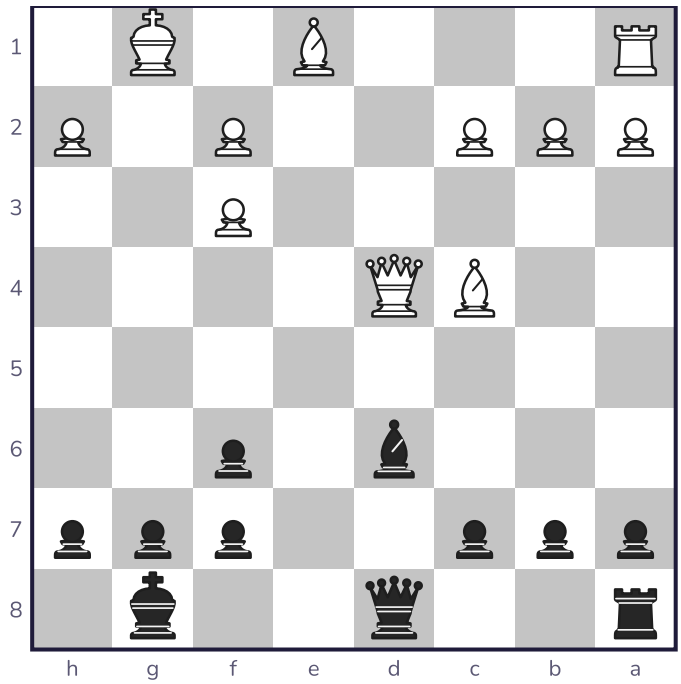
Two moves. Look for a pin.

23 INTERMEDIATE — Black to play



Two moves. Look for a discovered attack.

24 INTERMEDIATE — Black to play

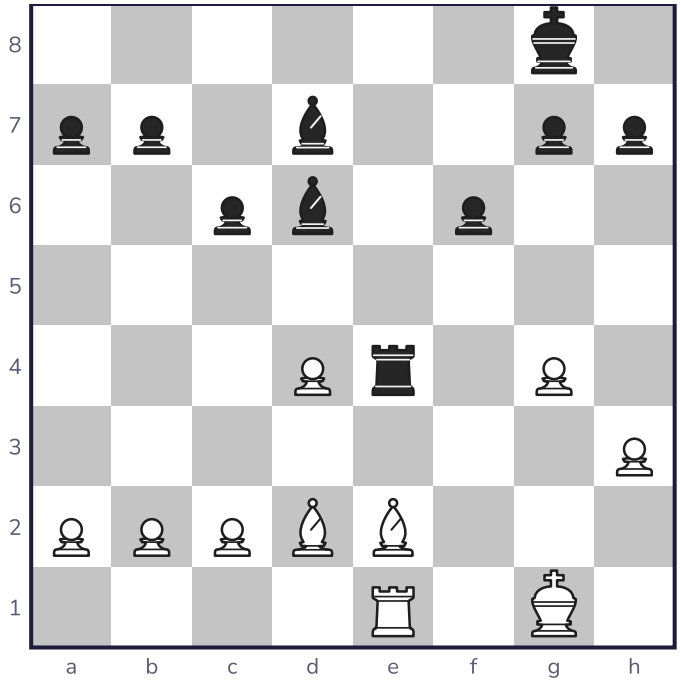


Two moves. Look for a discovered attack.

Puzzles 25 to 28

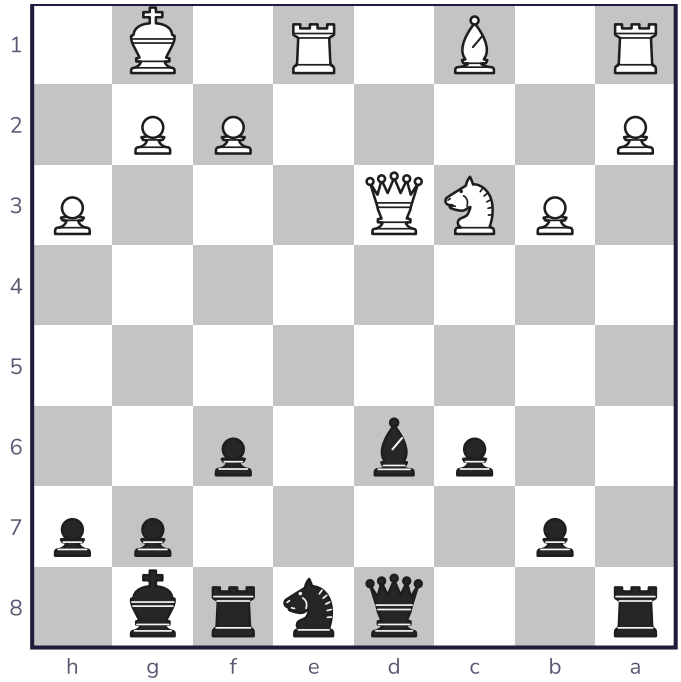
Name: _____

25 INTERMEDIATE — White to play



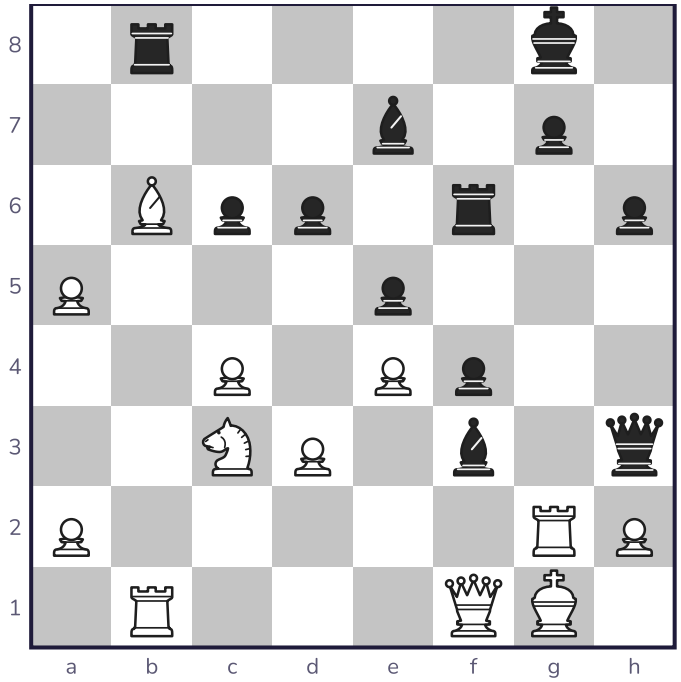
Two moves. Look for a discovered attack.

26 INTERMEDIATE — Black to play



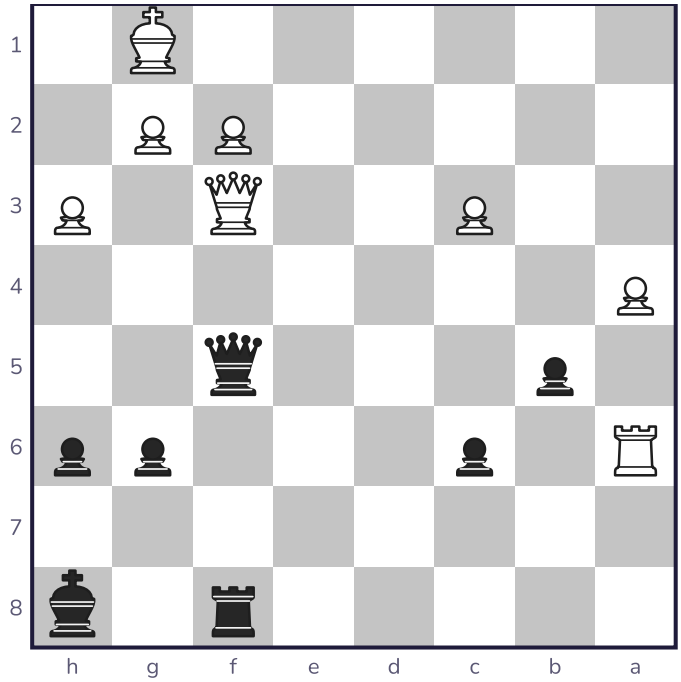
Two moves. Look for a discovered attack.

27 INTERMEDIATE — White to play



Two moves. Look for a discovered attack.

28 INTERMEDIATE — Black to play



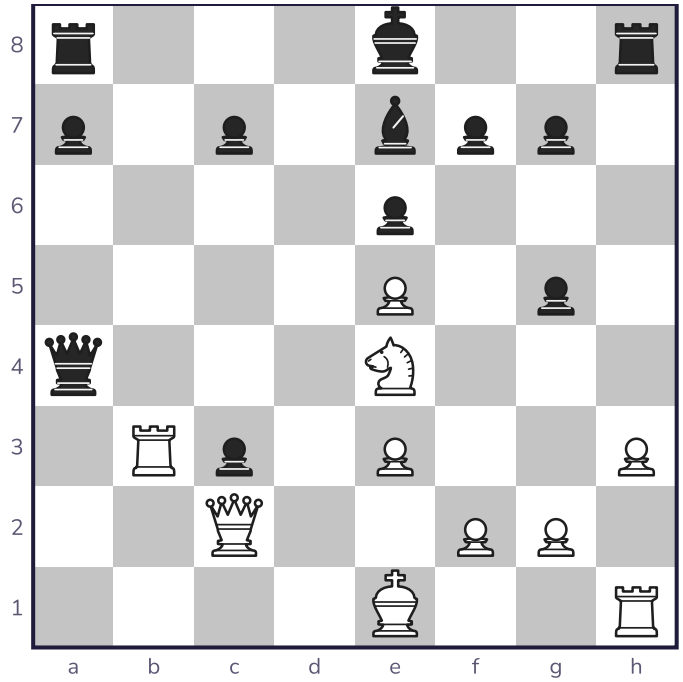
Two moves. Look for a discovered attack.

Puzzles 29 to 32

Name: _____

29 INTERMEDIATE

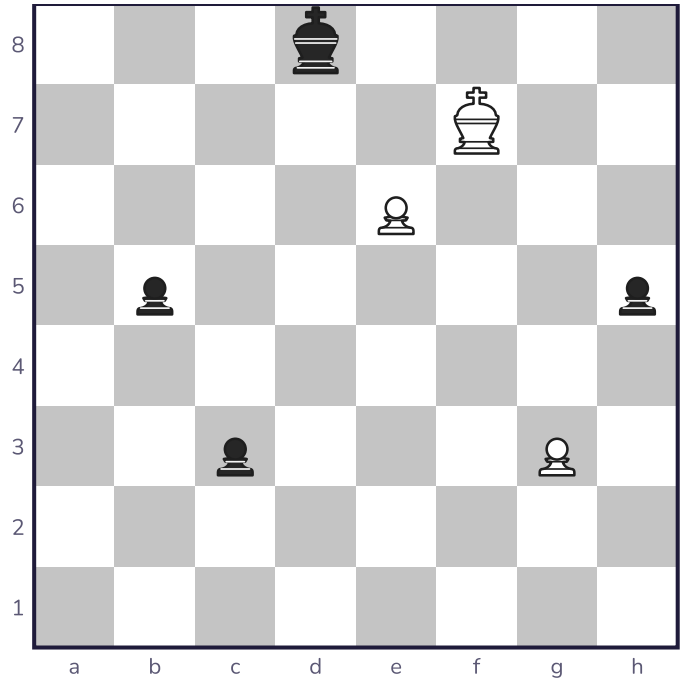
White to play



Two moves. Look for a discovered attack.

30 INTERMEDIATE

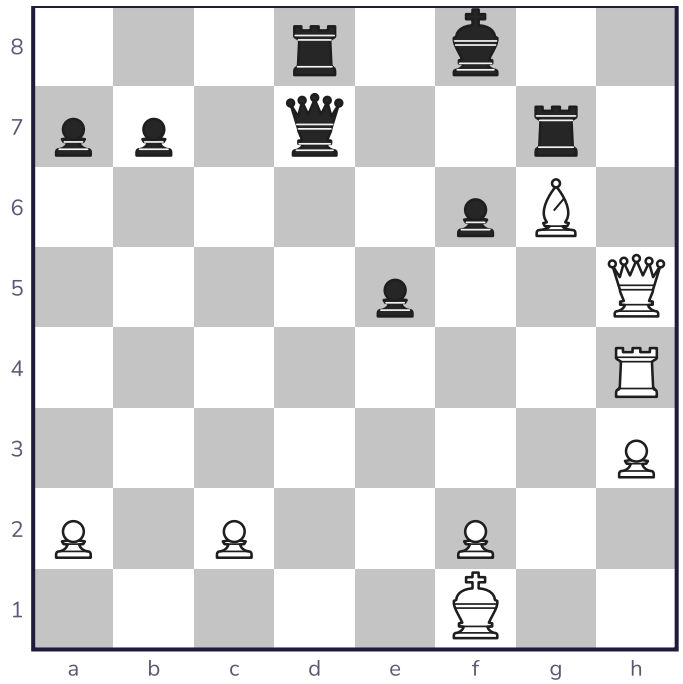
White to play



Two moves. Pull a defender away.

31 INTERMEDIATE

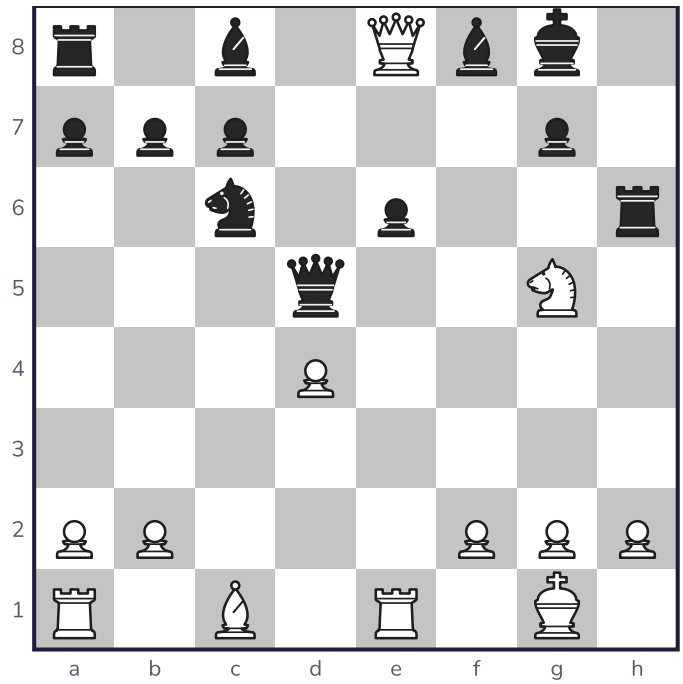
White to play



Two moves. Pull a defender away.

32 INTERMEDIATE

White to play



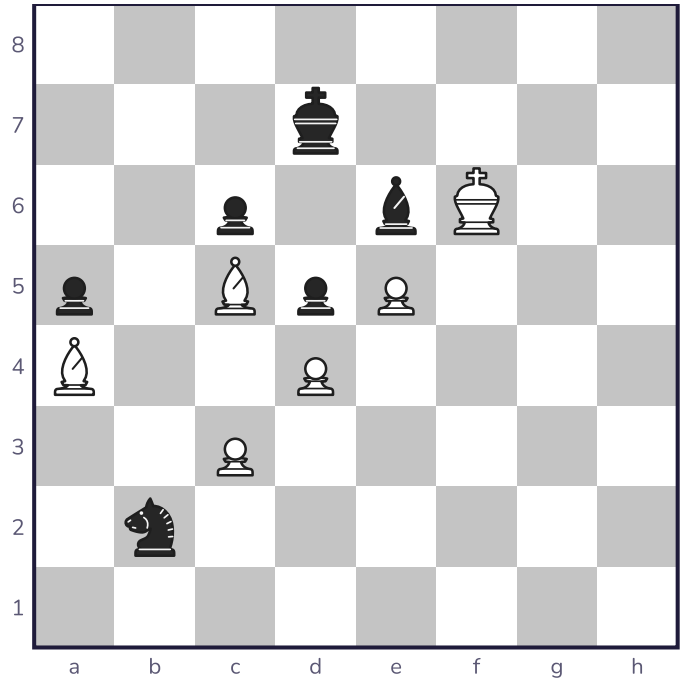
Two moves. Pull a defender away.

Puzzles 33 to 36

Name: _____

33 INTERMEDIATE

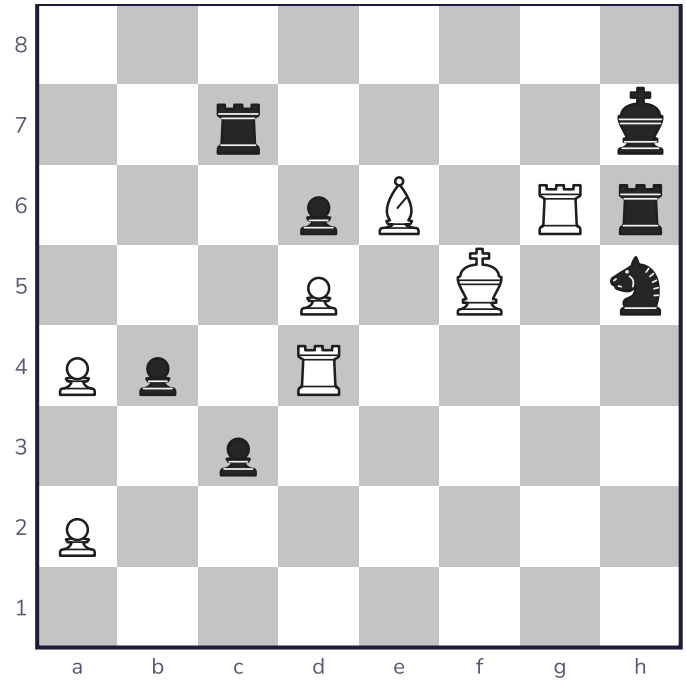
White to play



Two moves. Pull a defender away.

34 INTERMEDIATE

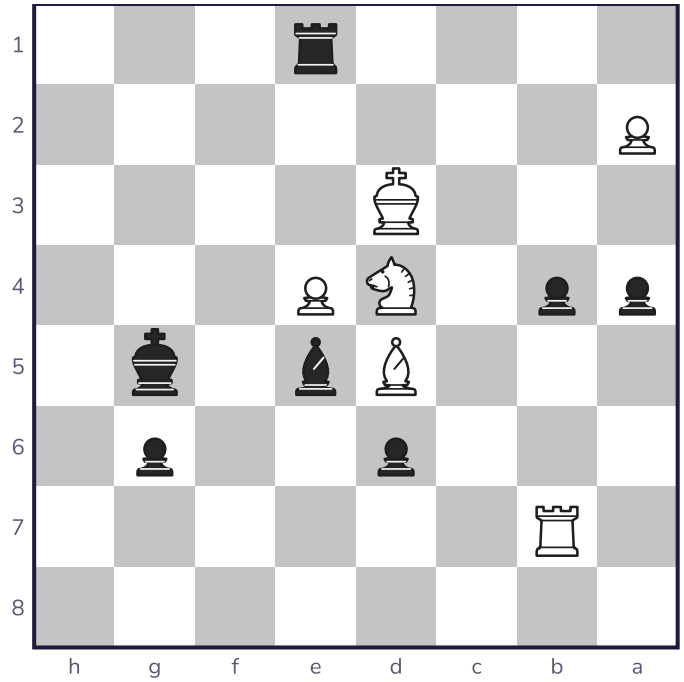
White to play



Two moves. Pull a defender away.

35 INTERMEDIATE

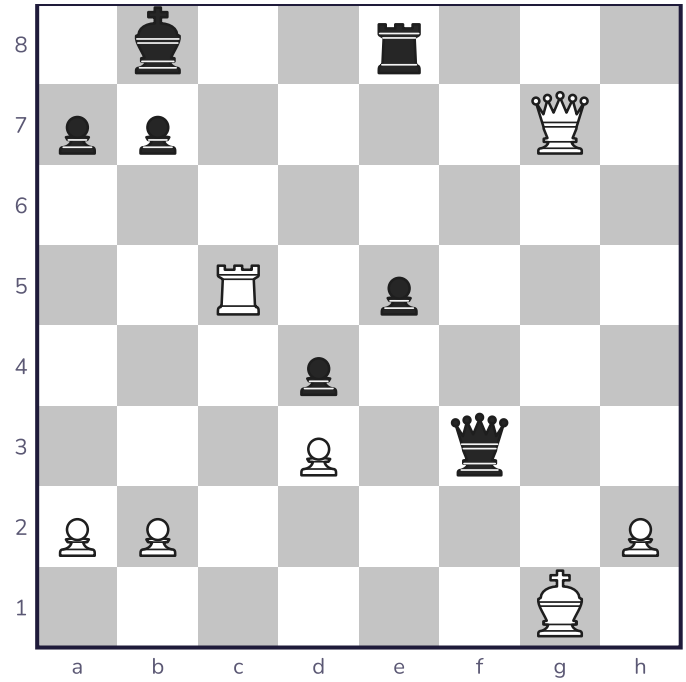
Black to play



Two moves. Pull a defender away.

36 ADVANCED

White to play

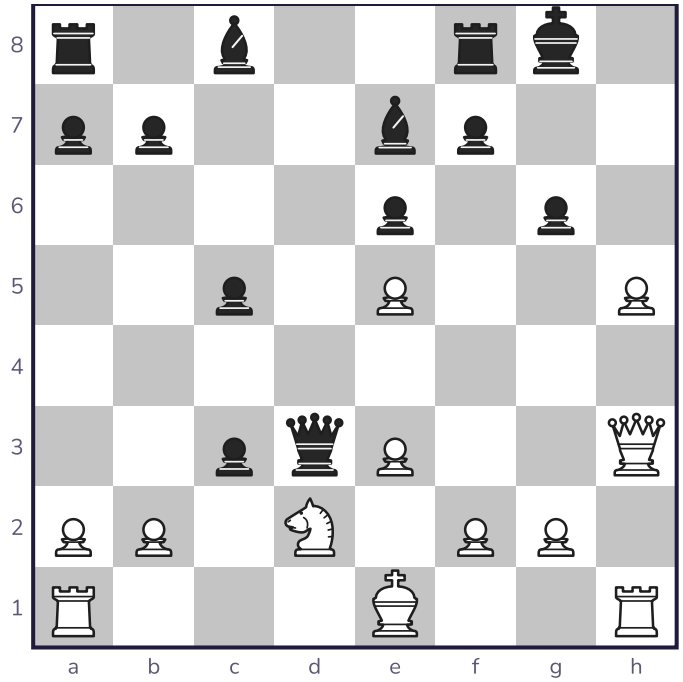


Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

Puzzles 37 to 40

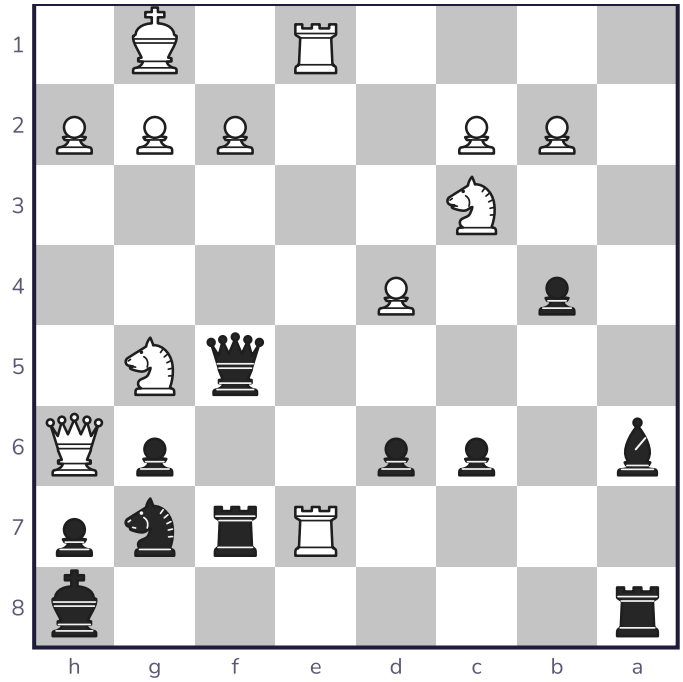
Name: _____

37 ADVANCED — White to play



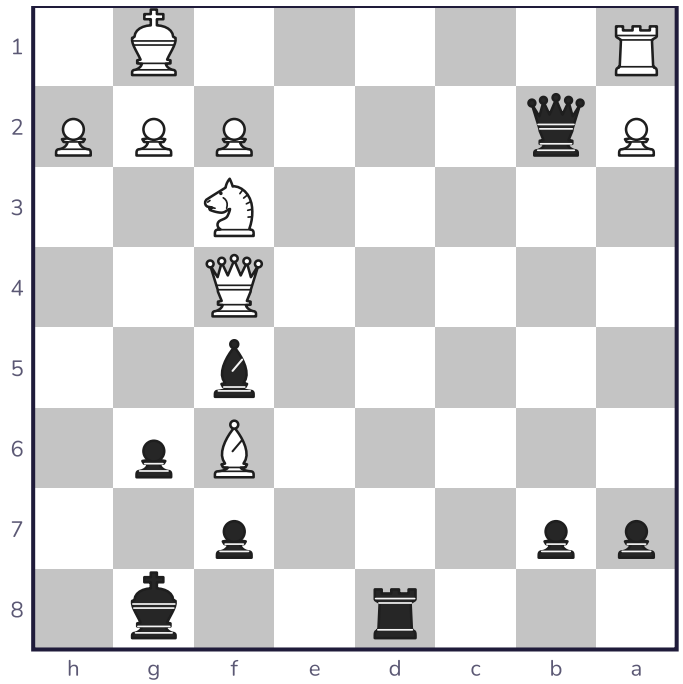
Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

38 ADVANCED — Black to play



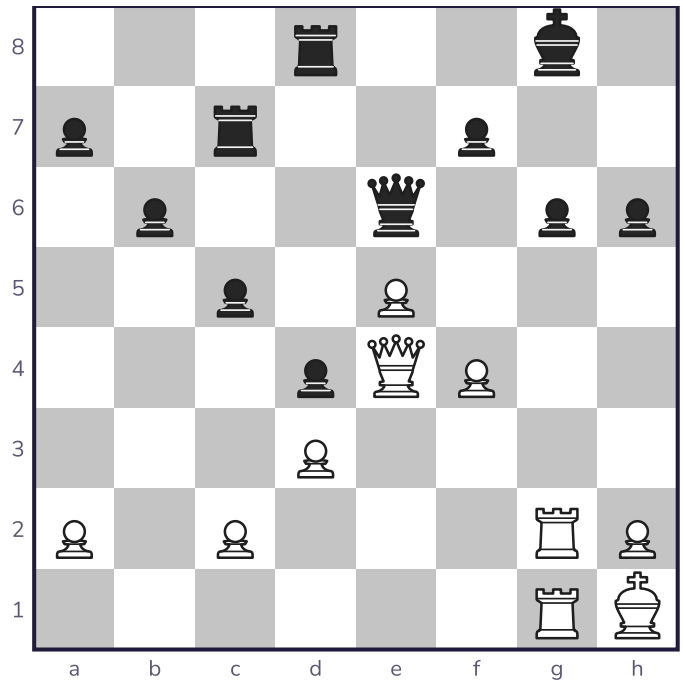
Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

39 ADVANCED — Black to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

40 ADVANCED — White to play



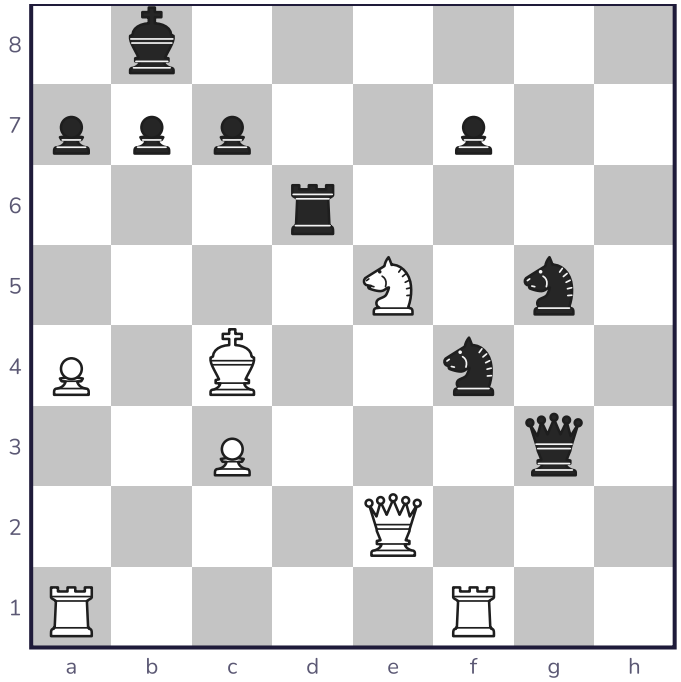
Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

Puzzles 41 to 44

Name: _____

41 ADVANCED

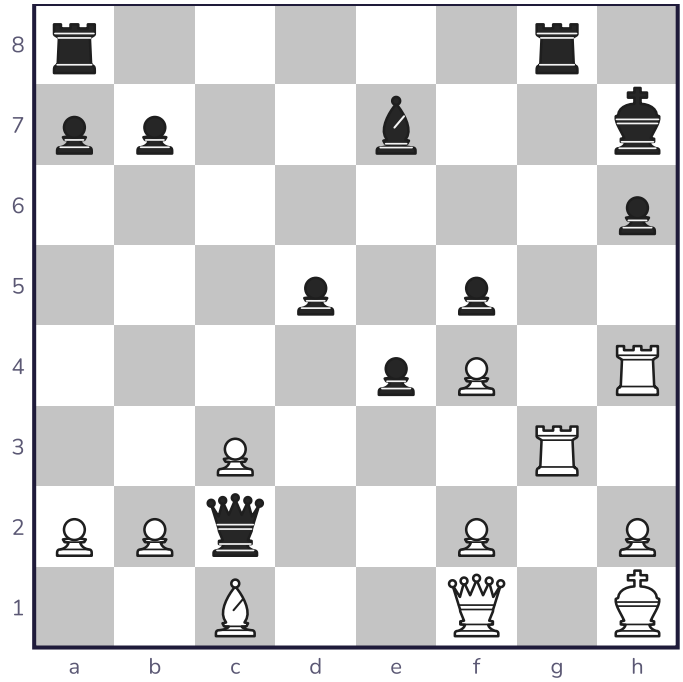
White to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

42 ADVANCED

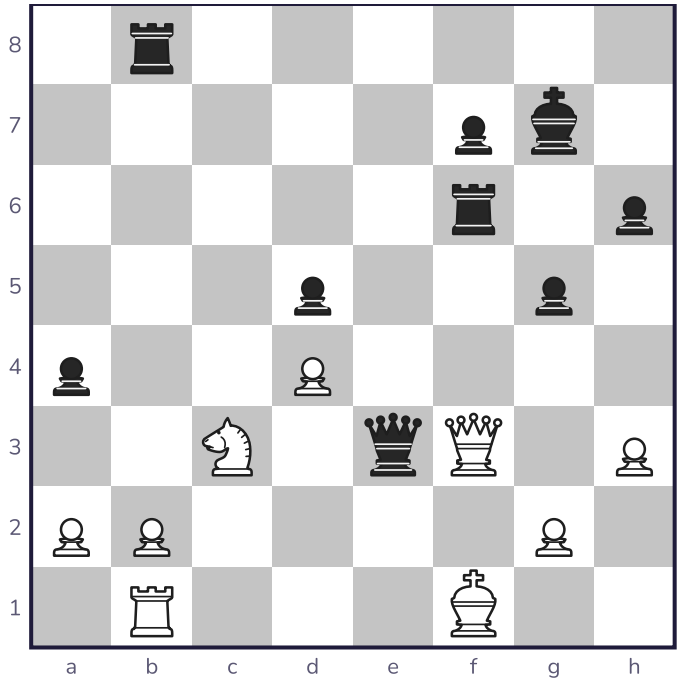
White to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

43 ADVANCED

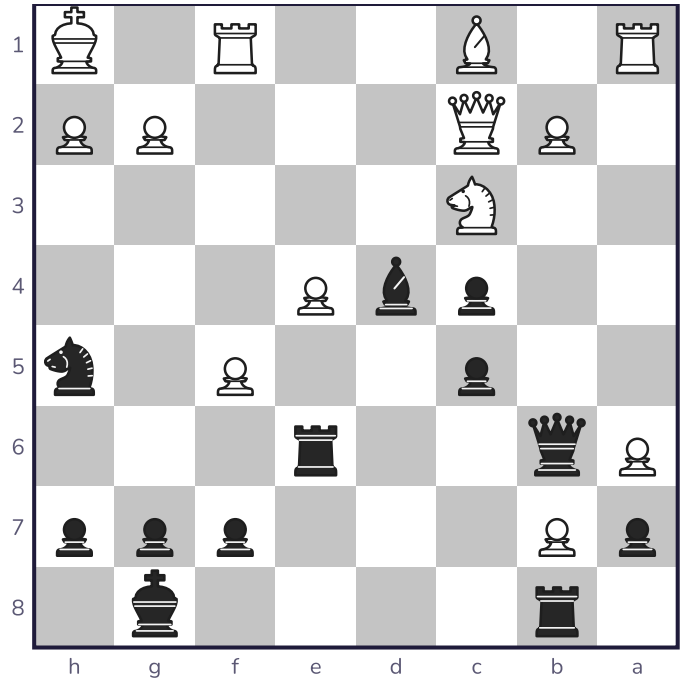
White to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

44 ADVANCED

Black to play



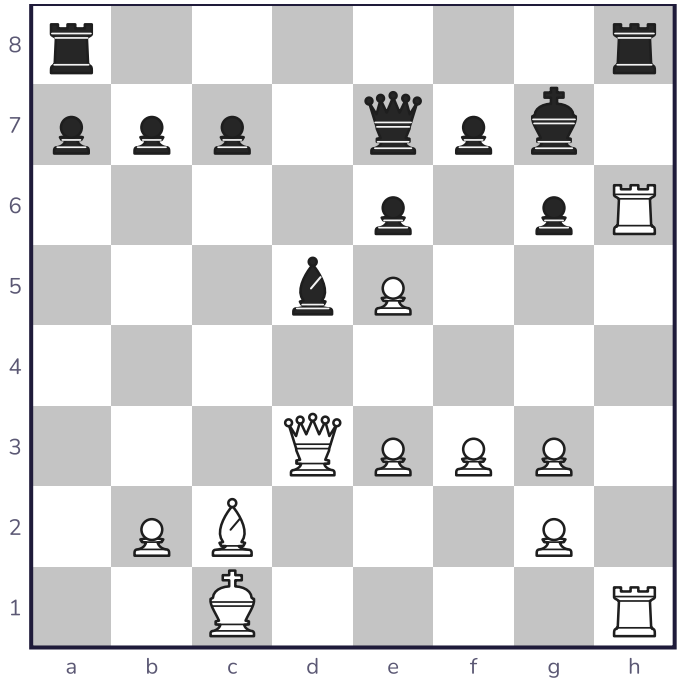
Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

Puzzles 45 to 48

Name: _____

45 ADVANCED

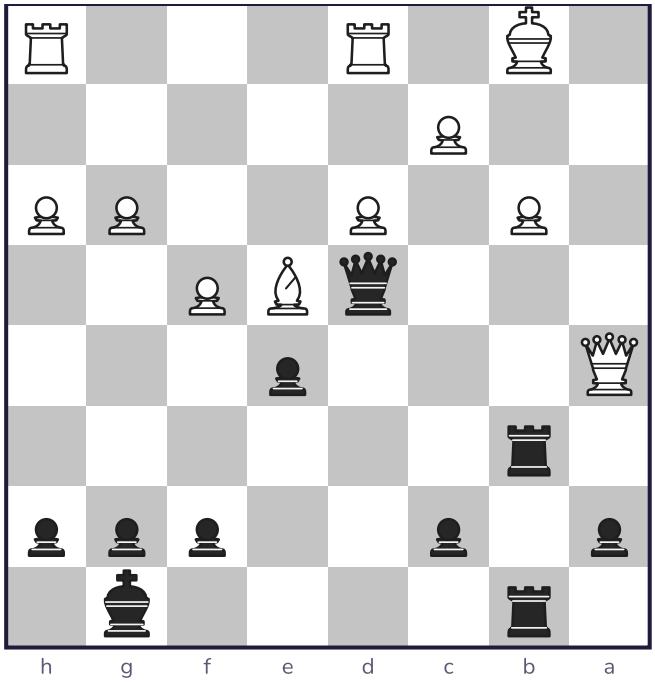
White to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

46 ADVANCED

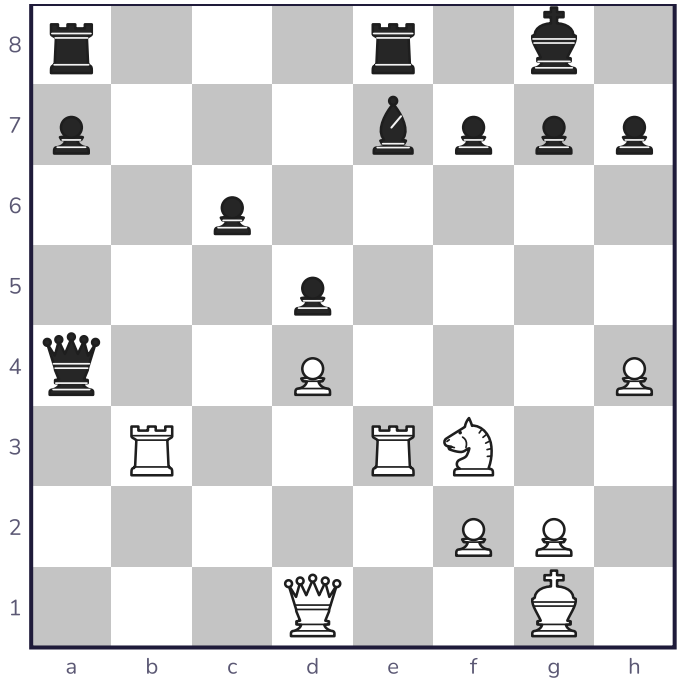
Black to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

47 ADVANCED

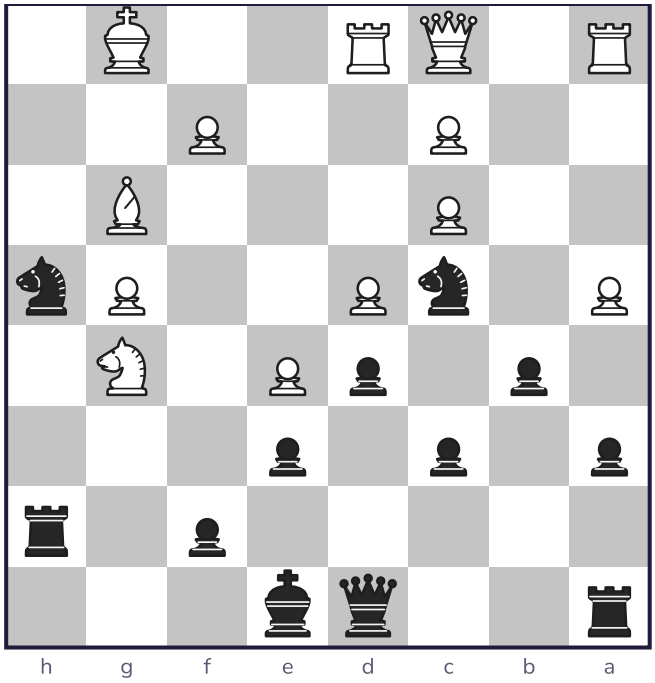
White to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

48 ADVANCED

Black to play



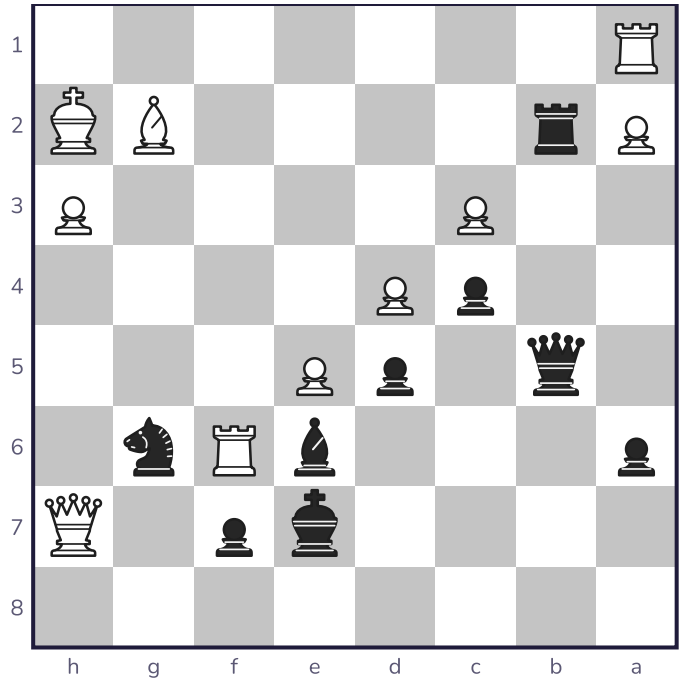
Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

Puzzles 49 to 50

Name: _____

49 ADVANCED

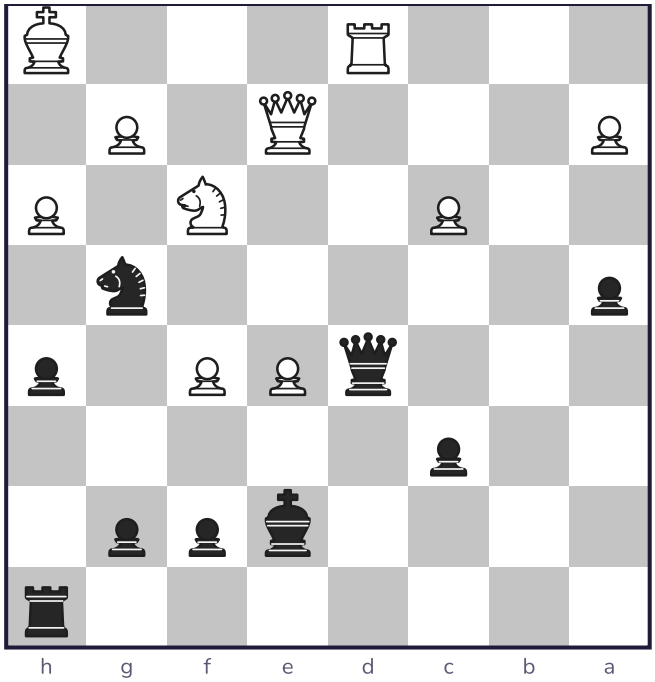
Black to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

50 ADVANCED

Black to play



Three moves. Something has to be given up first.

Answers

No peeking until you have written your move

1. Rxg8# (Lichess 2TdRy, rated 417)

2. Qxg7# (Lichess Vdhga, rated 449)

3. Rxf8# (Lichess 01gl3, rated 470)

4. Rf8# (Lichess 02HQm, rated 490)

5. Qxd2# (Lichess cdXey, rated 511)

6. Qh7# (Lichess jlxa2, rated 529)

7. Rd8# (Lichess Dgx6P, rated 547)

8. Qe8# (Lichess G7iHZ, rated 563)

9. Nd6# (Lichess gHwC2, rated 572)

10. Bxg6# (Lichess 20tpG, rated 594)

11. Nd3+ (they reply Kd2), then **Nxf2** (Lichess RBX58, rated 500)

12. Qxg5 (they reply Rg4+), then **Qxg4** (Lichess lHqKG, rated 554)

13. Nxe3+ (they reply Kf3), then **Nxd5** (Lichess qWyq3, rated 575)

14. Nxf5+ (they reply Ke4), then **Nxg3+** (Lichess gAoDo, rated 588)

15. Bd5+ (they reply Kf8), then **Bxb3** (Lichess nZBkc, rated 596)

16. Ra8 (they reply Kh7), then **Rxb8** (Lichess f9acP, rated 714)

17. Rxe3 (they reply Qxe3+), then **Kxe3** (Lichess fDl0D, rated 786)

18. Be3 (they reply Kb1), then **Bxd2** (Lichess w9Cqh, rated 869)

19. Nf3+ (they reply Kh1), then **Rf1#** (Lichess BLrRk, rated 889)

20. Kxf1 (they reply Kd7), then **Rxc5** (Lichess Jd07U, rated 935)

21. Bd5 (they reply Qxd5), then **Rxd5** (Lichess JYo0g, rated 962)

22. Ng3+ (they reply Qxg3), then **Bxg3** (Lichess d6Zah, rated 992)

23. Re1+ (they reply Rxe1), then **Qxf4** (Lichess coVMi, rated 664)

24. Bxh2+ (they reply Kxh2), then **Qxd4** (Lichess RbSjD, rated 739)

25. Bc4+ (they reply Kf8), then **Rxe4** (Lichess KQDBY, rated 787)

26. Bh2+ (they reply Kxh2), then **Qxd3** (Lichess iWYhB, rated 831)

27. Rxg7+ (they reply Kxg7), then **Qxh3** (Lichess 282vK, rated 897)

28. Qb1+ (they reply Kh2), then **Rxf3** (Lichess pMEYq, rated 935)

29. Rb8+ (they reply Rxb8), then **Qxa4+** (Lichess 02eE7, rated 980)

30. e7+ (they reply Kc7), then **e8=Q** (Lichess x5gpz, rated 697)

31. Qh8+ (they reply Ke7), then **Qxg7+** (Lichess VKTFo, rated 833)

32. Qf7+ (they reply Kh8), then **Qxf8#** (Lichess 4NIeJ, rated 886)

33. Bxc6+ (they reply Kxc6), then **Kxe6** (Lichess x4nMG, rated 934)

34. Bg8+ (they reply Kh8), then **Rxh6+** (Lichess a4jPJ, rated 968)

35. Rd1+ (they reply Ke2), then **Rxd4** (Lichess 9KDVR, rated 990)

36. Qc7+ (they reply Ka8), then **Qc8+** (they reply Rxc8), then **Rxc8#** (Lichess 09zYo, rated 1020)

37. hxg6 (they reply cxd2+), then **Kd1** (they reply Qf1+), then **Rxf1** (Lichess J6uco, rated 1060)

38. Qxf2+ (they reply Kh1), then **Qf1+** (they reply Rxf1), then **Rxf1#** (Lichess WolcQ, rated 1090)

39. Qxa1+ (they reply Bxa1), then **Rd1+** (they reply Ne1), then **Rxe1#** (Lichess nM4XU, rated 1115)

40. Rxg6+ (they reply fxg6), then **Rxg6+** (they reply Qxg6), then **Qxg6+** (Lichess s2WvT, rated 1153)

41. Nd7+ (they reply Rxd7), then **Qe8+** (they reply Rd8), then **Qxd8#** (Lichess iJjFY, rated 1173)

42. Rxh6+ (they reply Kxh6), then **Qh3+** (they reply Bh4), then **Qxh4#** (Lichess mD9Au, rated 1195)

43. Qxf6+ (they reply Kxf6), then **Nxd5+** (they reply Kf5), then **Nxe3+** (Lichess hLRnA, rated 1241)

44. Ng3+ (they reply hxg3), then **Rh6+** (they reply Bxh6), then **Qxh6#** (Lichess zpLtl, rated 1274)

45. Rxg6+ (they reply fxg6), then **Qxg6+** (they reply Kf8), then **Rxh8#** (Lichess cKvVo, rated 1321)

46. Rxb3+ (they reply cxb3), then **Rxb3+** (they reply Kc2), then **Qb2#** (Lichess 6ar49, rated 1350)

47. Rxe7 (they reply Rxe7), then **Rb8+** (they reply Rxb8), then **Qxa4** (Lichess 7alpr, rated 1388)

48. Qxg5 (they reply Qxg5), then **Nf3+** (they reply Kg2), then **Nxg5** (Lichess 00Kq4, rated 1419)

49. Rxg2+ (they reply Kxg2), then **Qb2+** (they reply Rf2), then **Qxa1** (Lichess 8iOyX, rated 1452)

50. Qxd1+ (they reply Qxd1), then **Nf2+** (they reply Kh2), then **Nxd1** (Lichess clLjo, rated 1479)